According to Buchanan's informant, Jainism had once been widespread throughout India: 'They allege that formerly they extended over the whole of *Arya* or *Bharata-Khande*, and that all those who ever had just pretensions to be of Kshatri descent were of their sect. It appears that until the time of Rama Anuja Acharya [Ramanuja, eleventh-century Vaishnava theologian and famous enemy of Jainism] many powerful princes of the south of India were their followers.'

Buchanan also learned that the centre of Jainism in South India was not Moodabidri but further inland at Sravana Belgola, near the fortress-town of Seringapatam (Srirangapatnam). He subsequently visited Sravana Belgola in May 1801 but was confined to his tent by an eye-infection which prevented him from seeing for himself the huge statue that dominates one of the two great hemispheres of exposed rock that flank the little village of Sravana Belgola. So painful did this infection become that Buchanan was forced to break off his enquiries and head back to Seringapatam for medical attention.

Buchanan's loss was Mackenzie's gain. After reading Buchanan's published account Mackenzie hurried to Sravana Belgola, his band of pandits and artists now strengthened by the inclusion of a Jain pandit named Durmiah from Mysore, who was not only able to assist with inscriptions written in Halegannada or 'Old Kannada' script, but also provided Mackenzie with more information about Jain history – some of it wildly inaccurate, such as the notion that the Jains were refugees from Mecca. The outcome was Mackenzie's *Account of the Jains*, published in 1807 in the ninth volume of the Asiatic Society of Bengal's august journal *Asiatick Researches*.

Mackenzie went on to become Surveyor-General of India. He had always planned to put to good use his vast collection of manuscripts, inscriptions, drawings and other material gathered during his surveys but he died in Bengal in 1821 with his papers uncatalogued. Dr Horace Wilson, then